



Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in

English Literature (4ET1/02R)

Paper 2: Modern Drama and Literary Heritage Texts

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

- When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.
- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their

professional judgement to the candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

Assessment Objectives

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

SECTION A – Modern Drama

Question number	Indicative content
1 <i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose the extent to which they agree that Catherine is to blame for Eddie's downfall. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Catherine is Eddie's niece, 17 years old, and, at first, she seems subservient to Eddie but she can be strong-willed and takes sides against him when she meets and falls in love with Rodolpho. Her wilfulness could be seen as fuelling Eddie's obsessive jealousy, which causes his death • Beatrice warns Catherine that she is a grown woman and should behave like one by not walking round in front of Eddie in her slip. She can see that this behaviour is leading to unhealthy feelings within Eddie, but Catherine has not realised the effect she is having on him • Catherine could be seen as impulsive and naïve when she falls in love with Rodolpho so quickly and then plans to marry him. She even tries to persuade Rodolpho to lie to Eddie by saying 'tell him you'd live in Italy – just tell him'. She knows that Eddie is worried that Rodolpho just wants to marry her to gain American citizenship, and she thinks this will pacify him. She cannot understand Eddie's strong reaction to their relationship, even though he has looked after her for years, which could be viewed as ungrateful • Catherine is desperate to be independent and be free of Eddie's control. She tells Rodolpho 'I'm afraid of Eddie here'. Her flirtations with Rodolpho create intense jealousy in Eddie, which results in Eddie becoming both verbally and physically aggressive in his efforts to protect her • when Eddie sees Catherine and Rodolpho entering her bedroom, he orders Rodolpho to leave and threatens him. His reaction in kissing Catherine and then Rodolpho oversteps the bounds of decency. It could be viewed that Catherine has driven him to this: 'Don't make me do nuttin' Catherine', but it is Rodolpho not Eddie who stands up for her honour when he says 'Stop that! Have respect for her!' At this point the audience must question Eddie's motives • Catherine becomes estranged from Eddie which makes him become more desperate to win her back. This results in his reporting Marco and Rodolpho to the authorities and breaking the code of honour • at the end of the play when Eddie dies, Catherine feels guilty for all that has happened and has not realised it could all end so tragically. She says 'Eddie, I never meant to do nothing bad to you'.

(AO2)

- Language: when Beatrice tells Catherine she must break free from Eddie to become more independent, she uses contrasting language to show how Catherine has changed from a girl to a woman. The key words in their duologue are 'baby', 'little girl' and then 'grown woman'. Whilst she is not saying that Catherine is guilty of anything other than girlish affection, she makes it clear that she feels that Catherine's behaviour has helped foster Eddie's feelings for her
- Language: Eddie's language becomes more frustrated and hostile as he realises that he is losing Catherine to Rodolpho. He tells Alfieri 'When I think of that guy layin' his hands on her I could – I mean it's eatin' me out, Mr Alfieri'
- Language: Eddie accuses Rodolpho of being 'weird', questioning his sexuality. A lot of his insults are based on his view of Rodolpho as effeminate, such as his having blond hair and his singing of 'Paper Doll'
- Form: the play takes the form of a tragedy with Alfieri virtually giving a funeral sermon for Eddie. He does not condemn Eddie and in some ways he admires him: 'And so I mourn him – I admit it – with a certain ... alarm'. This suggests that Eddie brought his downfall on himself, rather than Catherine
- Structure: the relationship between Catherine and Eddie provides the play's central tension and leads ultimately to the tragic downfall of Eddie
- Structure: the power in the play between Eddie and Catherine shifts as different characters seek to dominate. Initially, Eddie holds the power, but this changes as Rodolpho replaces him in Catherine's affections. Catherine confirms this shift in power when she chooses Rodolpho, which leads to Eddie's demise.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
2 A View from the Bridge	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the play is set in an area of New York where there are many immigrants, which makes the challenge that immigrants face in fitting into a new culture an important theme, and it can lead to a lot of conflicts between the characters - Eddie, as a poor but hard-working Italian in Red Hook, sees his role as upholding the code of conduct of his community. He tells Rodolpho that he is breaking his family's honour by taking Catherine out without asking his permission. This challenges his position as the head of the household and guardian to Catherine - when Catherine says she wants to marry Rodolpho, Eddie sees that as a shift in his role as her protector. He is convinced that Rodolpho just wants her as his wife to gain American identity and change his status from being illegal. He challenges his love for her and accuses Rodolpho of 'taking her for a ride', claiming that Rodolpho gives him the 'heeby-jeebies' - later in the play, Eddie is challenged to make a choice which goes against his own code of justice by informing the authorities about Marco and Rodolpho being illegal immigrants. He is trusted as the head of the family but when he feels his role is being threatened, he acts obsessively and out of character - Marco and Rodolpho have had to face many challenges in migrating to America and working in Brooklyn. Marco has a wife back in Italy and is prepared to work hard in a very different environment and culture to support his family. Rodolpho, on the other hand, wants to marry an American woman and become an American citizen, which will change his culture and challenge his loyalty - Alfieri was born in Italy but came to America when he was 25 years old and is now a respected New York lawyer. Although he has changed his cultural identity to become an educated Italian-American, he still has a lot of sympathy for the Italians in Red Hook and tries to give them good advice to make life better for them - Marco has not come to America for adventure or to change his culture. He wants to support his family and go back to Italy as soon as possible. Marco is proud to be Italian and does not understand American justice. He says 'The law? All the law is not in a book'. He is outraged by Eddie's behaviour and spits in his face to show his contempt for Eddie's going against his own code of justice in reporting them - ironically, this action leads to Marco's facing Eddie in a physical challenge and becoming Eddie's murderer, which is totally out of character for this quiet and peaceable man. The challenge of trying to live in the American culture without making sacrifices has proved too much for him - Eddie feels that Marco has taken away his identity by disrespecting him. He says to Rodolpho 'Marco's got my name ... he's gonna give it back to me in front of this neighbourhood, or we have it out'. Eddie links his identity to honour and respect, which he gains partly through his control of others.

(AO2)

- Language: Marco recognises the power and importance of natural law and comments in plain terms that in his country Eddie 'would be dead now'
- Language: when Marco defends Rodolpho after Eddie's attack, he lifts the chair 'like a weapon'. The use of the simile shows how Marco is fiercely protective of his brother when challenged, but he avoids actual violence at this stage
- Language/Structure: Eddie's direct and, at times, challenging way of speaking contrasts with the calm, educated diction of Alfieri
- Form: the play has the structure of a Greek tragedy, ending with the death of a protagonist on stage and Alfieri acting as a Chorus to give the final epitaph. Eddie's death has much to do with his efforts to uphold his name and reputation as a powerful family man. The clash of culture with the Italian cousins leads to him taking actions, which are fatal
- Form/Structure: ironically, in trying to uphold the respect for his culture, Marco ends up committing murder by turning Eddie's knife on him. This changes his position in society, and his future is now unknown: he may be deported back to Italy or imprisoned in America, in which case he will not be able to return to his role as father
- Structure: Alfieri represents the bridge between the two different cultures. He acts as a go-between as well as an observer and adviser.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
3 An Inspector Calls	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • secrets are significant in the play. Inspector Goole exposes the secrets in the Birling family by entering their comfortable existence and making each one confess the secrets that form the basis of the relationships within the family. Each character's secret is different but is connected to the same overall theme of social responsibility • Mrs Birling refuses to believe that any of her family have secrets and will not accept responsibility for anything that she or members of her family have done to contribute to Eva Smith's/Daisy Renton's demise: 'I don't believe it ... I won't believe it'. She is so obsessed with social class and reputation that she cannot empathise with anyone she sees as inferior: 'I think she only had herself to blame' • Gerald's laissez-faire attitude to life is rooted in the power he gains from wealth and status. He views himself as superior to Sheila and the Birlings and it is significant that he feels no remorse in deceiving Sheila over his affair with Eva/Daisy. He is quite happy to continue with his engagement to Sheila even after the Inspector has exposed his secrets: 'What about this ring?' • Eric has concealed the most from his family. During the play Eric is exposed as a drunkard, the father of an illegitimate unborn child and a thief. But despite all his deceit he is capable of real feelings for others and learns to face up to his weaknesses: 'I say the girl's dead and we all helped to kill her – and that's what matters' • Sheila is the first to start to realise the deceitful lives that they have all been living and accepts her part in Eva's/Daisy's downfall. She becomes aware that the Inspector's role is to make them confess to their secrets: 'he's giving us the rope – so we'll hang ourselves' • the way characters define respectability and truth is significant. The Birlings and Crofts are of a wealthy class, which insulates them from the unpleasantness of reality and the truth. They are hypocritical, pretending to be honourable people, for example, Mrs Birling's sitting on the Brumley Women's Charity Organization when she is prejudiced against the young women who come to ask for help. Also, Gerald takes a mistress even though he is courting Sheila. (AO2) • Language: Priestley, significantly, represents the Inspector as being omniscient: he knows everything. Through dramatic irony he gives similar power to audiences, who start to understand more about the situation than the characters on stage. At the beginning of the play, Arthur Birling talks about getting a knighthood unless there is a 'scandal'. He jokes '<i>complacently</i>' as if nothing will happen, but audiences realise from the title that something will happen and that an inspector will call

	• Language: Gerald uses a common euphemism to describe the setting of the bar at the theatre: 'favourite haunt of women of the town'. This leads audiences to wonder why he was there in the first place and what secrets he has • Language/Form: Mrs Birling demands that the Inspector does his 'duty' and finds the unborn child's father, whom she describes as a 'drunken young idler'. The dramatic irony of Mrs Birling persistently placing blame on the father builds suspense before she realises that the father is her own son, and that she has unwittingly passed judgement on Eric • Form/Structure: the play is structured like a whodunnit story, slowly uncovering the truth through the Inspector's careful questioning. He persuades the characters to reveal things that they would rather were not known • Structure: significantly, perhaps the biggest secret is revealed at the end of the play when the characters and audiences realise that Inspector Goole is a 'fake'. The name 'Goole' is like 'ghoul' or phantom and he could be viewed as some kind of spirit sent on behalf of the dead girl to test the consciences of her tormentors. The cliffhanger ending leaves it open for audiences to consider what is likely to happen next.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
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Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
4 An Inspector Calls	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to discuss the presentation of any character they consider is most affected by the events of the play. They are likely to choose Eva Smith/Daisy Renton, Sheila or Eric, but any choice is valid. Responses should be assessed based on the arguments presented • all the characters are affected by events, most obviously Eva/Daisy, who takes her own life because of the treatment she received from the Birling family and Gerald Croft before the play opens. However, the Birlings become affected too by the questioning and scrutiny of the Inspector and the secrets that are revealed • Sheila's engagement to Gerald is the reason for the dinner party hosted by the Birlings. Sheila is light-hearted and jovial, but she does mention that Gerald 'never came near' her the previous summer. Audiences later learn that this is the time that he was having an affair with Eva/Daisy. When this is revealed, Sheila breaks off the engagement, and the night as well as her future are ruined • Eric is isolated from the rest of his family and feels his parents do not understand him: 'You don't understand. You never did'. He has become a heavy drinker and lacks self-control. His odd behaviour hints that his secrets will later come out and threaten the Birlings' way of life. When he does confess to his affair with Eva/Daisy and making her pregnant, he changes his attitude and starts to stand up to his parents for the first time: 'The fact remains that I did what I did. And Mother did what she did. And the rest of you did what you did to her' • Mr Birling is presented as a wealthy employer of many working-class people in his factory. His power could be viewed as being most potentially affected by the events of the play. Mr Birling brags about exercising his power when the workers tried to obtain higher wages by striking, but his power and control is threatened by the Inspector's arrival and his bragging has no influence on him: he refuses the offer of a drink and says 'I don't play golf'. Mr Birling's '<i>hard-headed, practical</i>' approach to life is challenged by the Inspector and by the end of the play he is in danger of a 'scandal', which will ruin his reputation and chance of a knighthood • Gerald is also affected by events when the Inspector forces him to admit his affair with Eva/Daisy and Sheila breaks off the engagement. However, he is not presented as remorseful, like Eric, and appears to have learned nothing from the evening, still believing that he can continue with his engagement to Sheila once the Inspector has gone • Mrs Birling is affected by having to face the truth when she finds out that her son is a drunkard and the man she has condemned for having made Eva/Daisy pregnant. However, she will not accept responsibility for her actions, even when Eric and Sheila are both shocked by her treatment of Eva/Daisy, and still claims that she did the right thing: 'I accept no blame for it'. She may be affected by events, but she is too proud to admit it. (AO2)

- Language: Mrs Birling's words create dramatic irony when she says: 'I blame the young man who was the father of the child she was going to have', without realising that's she is condemning her own son. Finding out that Eric is the father could bring shame on the family
- Language: Sheila's language changes as she becomes more aware of her responsibilities after being questioned by the Inspector. At first, her language is presented as childish and, when she gets the ring, she looks for approval from her mother: 'Look – Mummy– isn't it a beauty!' By the end of the play, she is wiser and more mature in her outlook when she realises the Inspector's intentions: 'Well, he inspected us all right'
- Form: Priestley freezes the action between Acts to create tension and make audiences wonder what will happen to the characters next. Act One ends with the Inspector asking: 'Well?' Act Two opens with the same moment. At the end of Act Two there is another cliffhanger when the front door slams announcing Eric's return, but Priestley makes the audience wait until Act Three for Eric's confession. In this way, the action is slowed down so that audiences can take in the full effects of events on the characters
- Structure: mysterious events and coincidences form much of the play's tension and shape. Mr Birling is pontificating about the need for a man 'to mind his own business and look after himself and his own' when the doorbell rings, heralding the Inspector's arrival. Entrances and exits are very important in the play as they signify another character who will enter the Inspector's domain and whose life will be affected that night
- Structure: the ending of the play is mysterious. After the Inspector has left, audiences are left to wonder how much more the characters' lives will be affected once they receive the telephone call from a real police officer, stating that a girl has just died.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • animals are important to Christopher as he feels he can communicate better with animals than with people. His condition makes him view the world differently from others and he feels he can trust animals because they don't tell lies. He tells Siobhan 'I find people confusing', 'people do a lot of talking without using words'. He cannot read other people's body language or infer from their use of words • dogs show up frequently throughout the play usually representing <u>Christopher's</u> safety. This symbolism is particularly appropriate because dogs are often meant to protect the people around them. Christopher sees dogs as symbols of safety in the context of his relationship with Mrs Alexander. While always wary of her as a stranger, Christopher is more inclined to trust her because she has a dog, and he believes that people with dogs are generally nice • the death of the dog, Wellington, is an important event in the play as it sparks off Christopher's investigation into the dog's murder, which unwittingly leads him to discover that his mother is not dead. When Policeman One asks him if he killed the dog he says 'I like dogs', 'I did not kill the dog' • when his father accuses him of wasting too much time on investigating Wellington's death, telling him 'It's a bloody dog, Christopher', he replies 'I think dogs are important too'. This shows how much he respects animals even though others do not necessarily share his view • finding out that his father killed Wellington is important as it is the shock needed to make Christopher embark on his journey of independence and discovery. Up to this point he relied on his teacher, Siobhan, to explain things to him, but his home is no longer a safe place: 'I decided I couldn't stay home any more' • Christopher's pet rat, Toby, provides companionship for him. Toby is his closest friend and companion and gets taken everywhere with him throughout, even when he leaves home for London. At one point he risks his life down on the tube tracks to rescue Toby, unaware of the danger he is in. He tells the Station Officer 'He's very clean and he hasn't got bubonic plague'. This shows that he understands other people's dislike of rats • at the end of the play his father gives him a present of a golden retriever puppy for them to be able to share a 'project' together and for him to regain Christopher's trust. The dog immediately sits on Christopher's lap to show that he bonds with him. (AO2) • Language: when Christopher is preparing to go to London, the importance of his pet rat, Toby, is shown when he tries to find someone to care for him. He gives very precise instructions: 'He eats special pellets and you can buy them from a pet shop'

	• Language: after <u>Ed</u> tells Christopher that he killed Wellington, Christopher almost takes on dog-like qualities, barking whenever anyone bumps into him or frightens him. As he flees from his father's physical and emotional violence, Christopher's defense mechanisms become like those of the dog his father killed: <i>'Somebody bumps into Christopher. He barks at them like a dog'</i> • Form: dramatic tension is created when Toby escapes onto the tube tracks and audiences sense the danger Christopher puts himself in by trying to rescue him • Form/Structure: the discovery of Wellington's body is the important event that begins Christopher's detective work, as he begins to unravel the truth, and leads to a lot of dramatic conflict with his father. The discovery that his father murdered Wellington is the turning point in the play as he no longer trusts his father: <i>'Father had murdered Wellington. That meant he could murder me'</i> • Structure: the story begins with Christopher's discovery of the dead dog, Wellington. At this point, Christopher has no immediate worries for his safety, and in fact thinks himself responsible for others' safety as he tries to find Wellington's murderer. However, as he continues to investigate Wellington's death, Christopher encounters emotional danger in the form of his mother's letters and his father's confession • Structure: at the end of the play, Ed gives Christopher another dog, Sandy, as a pet. This gesture helps to repair the relationship between father and son and helps Christopher feel safer around Ed. Ed may have killed a dog at the beginning of the play, but at the end he brings a new one into the family, and this symbolic gift seems to heal many of the wounds that have been inflicted over the course of the play.
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	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the narrator of the play, Christopher Boone, is presented as a very talented 15-year-old: he knows a lot about space and mathematics. He finds people confusing, but notices the tiniest details about the world around him that most people would ignore: 'When the universe has finished exploding all the stars will slow down, like a ball that has been thrown into the air and they will come to a halt and they will all begin to fall backwards towards the centre of the universe again' - Christopher is presented as both the protagonist and the narrator of the play, meaning audiences experience the story from his point of view. His script is organised as a written account of Wellington's murder and his subsequent investigation: 'It was seven minutes after midnight. The dog was lying on the grass in the middle of the lawn in front of Mrs Shears' house' - although Christopher is the main narrator of the play, it is Siobhan who reads his lines from his book, becoming the narrator in Part One. This is because Christopher's condition makes it difficult for him to communicate with people he does not know - audiences see the world through Christopher's eyes and often they understand events better than he does. They recognise the clues he sees and misreads, for example, why his father does not like Mr Shears - because of his limited view of the world, it could be considered that Christopher is presented as an unreliable narrator. However, audiences quickly learn to decode what he is telling them, and they are always one step ahead of him. When he discovers his mother's letters it is obvious to audiences that his father has hidden them from him but Christopher searches for all possible reasons: 'Perhaps the letter was in the wrong envelope and it had been written before Mother died. Perhaps it wasn't a letter from Mother. Perhaps it was a letter to another person called Christopher' - one thing that makes him more reliable as a narrator is the fact that he cannot tell lies. He tells the Duty Sergeant 'I always tell the truth'. In many ways, Christopher is an exceptionally reliable narrator because of his excellent memory and unsentimental nature - Christopher's attention to detail makes him a very thorough and methodical detective: 'I see everything. Most people are lazy. They never look at everything'. We can trust that his facts are correct even if he draws the wrong conclusion from them at times. (AO2) - Language: Christopher's narration is very formal, factual and precise. In the opening scene, his narration, read by Siobhan, introduces him in this

	way: 'My name is Christopher John Francis Boone. I know all the countries of the world and the capital cities. And every prime number up to 7507' • Language: Christopher's measured, considered speech contrasts with his father's emotive and often angry dialogue, to which Christopher often struggles to respond • Form: the first-person perspective is as much of a technique as it is a key idea or theme. It presents the unique lens through which Christopher views the world • Form: the play is written in the form of a whodunnit and details about both the murder of Wellington and the death of Christopher's mother slowly come to light as both plots become intermingled • Form/Structure: the play features run-on scenes and all actors remain on stage throughout. In this way, Christopher's disjointed world is presented as he grows up and learns the truth about his family.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 Kinder-transport	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • just before the beginning of the Second World War, Eva is displaced by being sent to Manchester, England, from her home in Hamburg, Germany, on the Kindertransport, which has the effect of changing her life • she and her mother hope it will be a brief parting and that her mother will be able to join her in England, but the separation turns into years and the complete displacement of Eva into a foreign world and culture • leaving Germany on a train as a young girl has caused the displacement of Eva's identity. She appears on stage at first as a nine-year-old German girl but, as a British teenager, Eva renounces her religion and embraces her new culture, even changing her name from Eva to Evelyn • Eva/Evelyn never feels completely at home in England: she has been seen as a Jew in Germany but a German in Britain, so feels displaced in both countries. She tries to hide her past from her daughter, Faith, to provide a more secure life for her but the relationship between her and Faith is insecure. Faith accuses her of being 'a mother who walks out on you the moment you begin to disagree with her' • the displacement has affected Eva/Evelyn mentally as well as physically. She has panic attacks and is always cleaning as if to scrub away her past. Her marriage to Faith's father has broken down and she will not talk about the past. Her cleaning and need for order make her very selfish and controlling, which causes a rift between her and Faith • when Faith discovers her mother's box of German papers and photos, she asks about Eva's/Evelyn's German parents. Her mother tells her 'I think I must have loved them a lot at one time. One forgets what these things feel like. Other feelings displace the original ones' • Eva's/Evelyn's mother, Helga, realises the cost of displacing her daughter when she tries to reunite with her on her way to New York to start a new life after the war. Eva/Evelyn refuses to go with her and accuses Helga of casting her away: 'You threw me into the sea with all your baggage on my shoulders' • at the end of the play, Faith wants to travel to America to 'get in touch with her relatives'. As an only child, finding an extended family would mean a lot to Faith and she would feel less isolated but Eva/Evelyn refuses to go, telling her 'I'd rather die than go back'. For Evelyn the effect of the displacement is permanent. (AO2) • Language: Eva/Evelyn uses metaphorical and emotive language to describe the painful effects of her displacement: 'You cut off my fingers and you pulled out my hair one strand at a time'

	• Language: the abyss mentioned by Eva in the opening of the play is symbolic of the displacement and the subsequent loss and confusion that will occur when she leaves Germany: 'What's an abyss, Mutti?' • Form/Structure: Lil crosses time zones, creating a dramatic link between the experiences of Faith and her mother throughout the play's action. Her role is to act as a go-between for both women and ease the rift created by Eva's/Evelyn's displacement • Form/Structure: the use of split scenes on stage supports the important concept of the upheaval caused by displacement. Characters at different points of their lives appear on stage at the same time but do not see each other • Structure: at the end of the play, Faith is anxious to get in touch with their relatives to reduce the feeling of isolation whereas Eva/Evelyn refuses any link with the past, just as she did when her mother went to America all those years before. Faith makes the return that her mother feels unable to do, which gives audiences hope that at least one of them will find their roots.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 <i>Kinder-transport</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • three sets of interlinked parental relationships are shown in the play: Eva and her parents; Eva/Evelyn and Lil; Evelyn and Faith. None of these are shown as being very stable and conflict is shown in each • the role of parents is shown in the play to be very difficult, as shown by Faith's words to Lil when she rows with her mother Evelyn: 'How could I possibly not be a bad child with such a terrible mother!' • at the beginning of the play Helga sees her parental role as ensuring her daughter's survival. She faces the heartbreak of sending her young daughter on the Kindertransport to safety in England. Her gentle preparations for her daughter's journey are emotive and show her depth of love and sacrifice. When Eva/Evelyn asks for help with sewing, Helga refuses: 'You have to be able to manage on your own', as she knows that being independent is the only way Eva/Evelyn will survive • Lil takes on the role of parent to Eva/Evelyn when she arrives in England. She is very caring with a strong sense of integrity. Later, she tries hard to be a good support to both Eva/Evelyn and her daughter, Faith. Towards the end of the play, Eva/Evelyn harshly accuses her of being a 'Child-stealer' and tells her 'I wasn't your child', 'You made me betray her' [her mother, Helga] • Eva's/Evelyn's role as a parent is affected by her past. She suffers from enormous guilt over how she survived and how she treated her birth mother. Her disjointed upbringing affects her own ability to parent Faith. She cannot give love out freely and she is afraid of intimacy. She asks Faith if she is 'A terrible mother', 'You think I'm paranoid too, do you?' • Eva's/Evelyn's relationship with Faith is influenced significantly by her own relationships with Helga and Lil. When Helga comes back into her life when she is 17, Eva/Evelyn refuses to recognise her as her mother saying she is 'adopted by Mr and Mrs Miller' and will not leave England to go with Helga to America • Eva's/Evelyn's father is unable to play a full role in her life as he dies in Auschwitz. Initially, Eva/Evelyn holds out hope that her parents will be able to join her in England soon after she makes her own journey. She learns later from Helga: 'I lost your father. He was sick and they put him in line for the showers. I saw it' • Faith's father has not played a role in his daughter's life as he left Eva/Evelyn when Faith was little, although he does send money to Faith. Lil claims that part of Faith's anger is because of her lack of a father figure: 'It's probably still leftovers from her dad going'. (AO2) • Language: the lack of communication between Eva/Evelyn and Faith shows that Eva/Evelyn finds her role as a mother difficult. Her formal use of English contrasts with Faith's more relaxed register. Eva's/Evelyn's formality is controlling: 'This continual vacillation is not helpful to either of us'. By contrast, Faith is more direct: 'Jesus'

	• Language: Eva's/Evelyn's mother, Helga, uses a metaphor to describe how she views her role as a parent as precious: 'Do you understand what I mean about your being my jewels?', 'We all die one day but jewels never fade or perish' • Form: Eva's/Evelyn's continuous cleaning in the play's opening scenes, as revealed in the stage directions, reflects the tension in her role as mother to Faith: '<i>Evelyn continues to polish</i>'. It also symbolises Eva's/Evelyn's desire to wipe out the past • Structure: Eva's/Evelyn's precarious parental role is evident early in the play when she argues with Faith about the cost of rent for Faith's new flat. Eva/Evelyn says '<i>(polishing)</i> You said it was a bargain' to which Faith retorts 'Maybe you should have come to see it'. This friction continues until a dramatic climax is reached when Faith discovers her mother's past identity and feels anger about the secrets she has kept • Structure: when they leave the attic at the end of the play, audiences are left to speculate how the relationship between Eva/Evelyn and Faith will develop in the future once Faith has left. The question remains whether their relationship will be as fragmented as the relationship between Eva/Evelyn and her birth mother, Helga.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
9 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose how far they agree with the view that Elesin is a hero. Responses should be assessed based on the arguments presented • Elesin Oba, the King's Horseman, is the main character in the play. Part of his duty as the King's Horseman is to take his own life following the King's death: 'I have a duty to perform'. Elesin's role is to fulfil his duty and maintain the Yoruba's spiritual wellness and order. This could be seen as a heroic act and the women name him 'a man of honour' • as the play begins, it has been one month since the death of the King. In the time since the King's death, Elesin has been preparing for his journey to the afterlife. However, his own indecisiveness and the interference of Simon Pilkings, the District Officer, prevents him from carrying out his duty and brings shame on him and his family • candidates may take the view that Elesin loves his life and has not yet had enough time to fulfil his ambitions on Earth or enjoy physical pleasures. A modern view may deem the idea of his taking his own life as dishonourable rather than honourable, as life is precious. In this way, it could be claimed that he is not being weak but heroic in wanting more time on Earth • Elesin fails at his duty as the King's Horseman because he does not heed Iyalaja's warnings about connecting himself to the living world. He is reluctant to leave this world. He tells the women 'The world I know is good'. In his desperation to leave something of himself behind in this world, he insists on taking a bride before his death: 'My vital flow, the last from this flesh is intermingled with the promise of future life'. This could be viewed as selfish rather than heroic • it is clear that Olunde considers Elesin's lack of action unheroic. He chooses to take his father's place in the death ritual to preserve the integrity of his family and the natural order of the universe according to Yoruba traditions and beliefs. This could be viewed as a heroic act although Jane Pilkings views this as tragic, as he was destined to complete his training in England to become a doctor. She tells him 'Life should never be thrown deliberately away' • Elesin kills himself only after seeing that his son, Olunde, has taken his place by sacrificing his own life to join the King in the afterlife. Iyalaja scorns him for failing to carry out his duty saying 'There lies the honour of your household', 'The son has proved the father Elesin', 'The bush rat fled his rightful cause' • Elesin is unable to fulfil his duty to the people of Yoruba and the King by ending his own life. It is also the end of the line of King's Horsemen, since Olunde would have taken on this role after Elesin died, and he is now dead as well. The only saving grace might be if the Bride produces a son to carry on the Horseman tradition

- Elesin's delayed death is viewed by his people as cowardly and dishonourable. Iyaloja states 'he will arrive stained in dung' from the King's stallion into the afterlife, emphasising that his dishonor will follow him in death
- audiences might view Elesin as a tragic hero because he has originally been an honourable man who loves life, and it could be viewed that his death is pointless. To the Yoruba, he is a weak man who lets the people of his village down. The Praise-Singer says to him at the end of the play 'Elesin, we placed the reins of the world in your hands yet you watched it plunge over the edge of the bitter precipice'.

(AO2)

- Language: at the beginning of the play, Elesin enters along with drummers and praise-singers. He is described as a man who sings and dances with an '*infectious enjoyment of life*'. This description suggests that he is more invested in continuing to live than he admits and hints that he does not want to die even as a hero
- Language: Iyaloja often speaks in verse using Yoruba proverbs and explains their meaning for Elesin. By explaining the proverbs, she hopes to connect him more to Yoruba culture so that he will follow through with his duty: 'Richly, richly, robe him richly / The cloth of honour is *alari*'
- Form: the conflict Elesin feels, caught between his love of life and his duty to die to follow his King into the afterlife, is the central conflict of the text. Two deaths occur at the end of the play, which is a tragedy, but the natural order has not been restored in the traditional way
- Form/Structure: in this tragic play, which includes verse, Olunde's actions in taking his father's place provide the dramatic climax of the play. The empathy of audiences is transferred from Elesin to his son
- Structure: Soyinka presents the contrast very strongly between Elesin and Olunde, as Olunde fulfils his duty whilst Elesin fails to do so. This makes him heroic instead of his father, who is disgraced.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Soyinka makes it clear in the Author's Note that the play is not intended to be focused on the colonial powers at the time, but on the meaning of Elesin's death. Yet the impact of colonialism on the characters is clear. The city of Oyo has long been under the influence of the Western world as Nigeria has been occupied by colonisers. There is colonial conflict, as the English occupiers try to supplant local Yoruba beliefs and traditions with their own • Elesin tells Simon Pilkings 'You stole from me my first-born, sent him to your country so you could turn him into something in your own image'. By Pilkings supporting his son, Olunde, in going to England to study as a doctor, he has stopped Olunde from succeeding Elesin as the King's Horseman. Pilkings sent Olunde away to better himself, as he saw it • Pilkings, the District Officer, acts as the antagonist in the play. He represents British colonial rule and disrupts traditional Yoruba culture and tradition. He shows no respect for the Yoruba beliefs and customs, viewing them as 'nonsense' and 'mumbo-jumbo' • he prevents Elesin from carrying out his ritual suicide by jailing him. However, Elesin does also admit that Pilkings alone is not to blame but his own longing for life as well • Pilkings' discomfort surrounding Elesin's ritual suicide is centered on his need to prove to the Prince from England that Oyo is not a threat to the ruling power, rather than to his commitment to disbarring the Yoruba beliefs: 'I can't have a disturbance here' • when Olunde returns from England, Pilkings is hopeful that he will have been influenced enough by Western culture to help him stamp out local beliefs, but instead, he returns to maintain the ritual • the greatest threat to Pilkings' power is Yoruba culture itself. Though Amusa has converted to Islam, he is still unable to look at the Pilkingses while they are dressed in <i>egungun</i> costume. It is considered disrespectful to look at or touch the <i>egungun</i> costume at any time, especially while discussing death • Olunde takes his own life in order to maintain the Yoruba conception of the cosmic order. However, in fulfilling this order, Olunde also potentially ends it: he was supposed to take his father's place in life before he took it in death, and Olunde leaves behind no heir. There will be no next King's Horseman unless the gods will it so. The Praise-Singer says 'What the end will be, we are not gods to tell' and Iyaloja's final words are 'Turn your mind only to the unborn' • the deaths of Elesin and Olunde imply that a vital part of Yoruba culture has been ruptured under English colonial rule, unless the Yoruba gods are powerful enough to overcome it.

(AO2)

- Language: Olunde's direct and wise observations contrast with Elesin's metaphorical language. Olunde shows that he understands the white colonialists very well: 'Then I slowly realised that your greatest art is the art of survival. But at least have the humility to let others survive in their own way'
- Language: Elesin, like Olunde, realises that the white colonialists offer nothing. He uses a metaphor to describe Pilkings as 'ghostly one' and reflects on the colonialists' devastating impact on his people: '... who would have known that the white skin covered our future, preventing us from seeing the death our enemies had prepared for us'
- Form: Elesin is imprisoned and chained in an old slave cellar, which symbolises colonial control. Though Elesin does not travel to America like the slaves before him, he is suppressed by the whites and denied his dignity
- Form/Structure: it is the intervention of Pilkings in preventing Elesin from taking his own life that results in the death of Olunde and shaming of Elesin. This forms the central drama of the play, shown by the increasing volume of the drumming, which builds up tension
- Form/Structure: Simon and Jane Pilkings can be considered typical of British expats in Nigeria at the time the play is set. Their way of life and views are in direct conflict with Yoruba culture. Jane Pilkings gets annoyed with the drumming in the build up to the ritual suicide: 'I thought all bush drumming sounded the same'
- Structure: the Pilkingses represent the rigidity and blindness of colonial rule and British tradition as they were applied in the colonies.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

SECTION B – Literary Heritage Texts

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose how far they agree with the view that it is Romeo's own actions that are to blame for his downfall. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Romeo says 'O, I am fortune's fool!' when he has fought and unwittingly killed Tybalt, Juliet's cousin. Despite not wanting to fight Tybalt, Romeo was drawn into the fight to defend the honour of his friend, Mercutio, who has just been killed by Tybalt in a street brawl. Romeo feels that fate is against him as both deaths could have been avoided but his actions appear to him to be predetermined with unavoidable outcomes • candidates could take the view that Romeo is a foolish character and that it is his impulsive, dramatic, and obsessive personality that leads him into a hasty, secret marriage to Juliet Capulet, the daughter of a rival family. This leads to a lot of the problems the couple face and ultimately to both of their deaths • he goes to the Capulet ball uninvited, which could be viewed as a foolish act considering the feud between the families. This incurs Tybalt's wrath and leads him later to challenge him to the duel, which ends in tragedy: 'This intrusion shall, / Now seeming sweet, convert to bitt' rest gall' • after meeting Juliet at the ball, he is so overwhelmed by love for her that he can focus on nothing else and, even when he finds out her true identity and knows that their love will be forbidden, he makes what could be considered reckless decisions: 'My life were better ended by their hate, / than death prorogued, wanting of thy love' • however, candidates may offer the opposing view: that Romeo's choices and actions are ultimately determined by forces greater than him. From the beginning of the play, the Chorus sets the tone of a dark fate looming over the action: 'A pair of star-crossed lovers' • Romeo is aware of the unseen forces that control him, but he still tries to outsmart them, with disastrous results. When learning of Juliet's 'death', he tries to challenge the role of fate in hopes of reversing what the stars have ordained for him • despite his knowledge of his lack of control and the death sentence hanging over him, Romeo still plans to investigate the truth of his servant's, Balthasar's, news of Juliet's death, demonstrating that he still hopes to overcome fate. He tries to take fate into his own hands by taking poison so that he can die with her: 'O here / Will I set up my everlasting rest, / And shake the yoke of inauspicious stars'. Ironically, by taking his own life, he prevents his reunion with Juliet, which leads to her taking her own life as well

- the unnecessary deaths of both Mercutio and Tybalt, the non-arrival of the Friar's letter telling Romeo of his plan to drug Juliet so that she can avoid marrying Paris, and the timing of Romeo's death before the awakening of Juliet could all be viewed as acts of fate rather than Romeo's rash actions.

(AO2)

- Language: on being informed of Juliet's death, Romeo's defiant exclamation against fate could be seen as a heroic act: 'I defy you, stars!' It could also be considered the rash outburst of a desperate young man
- Language: Friar Lawrence also realises that he and Romeo are battling against fate when he states 'A greater power than we can contradict hath thwarted our intents', which shows that maybe Romeo did not stand a chance in fighting his destiny
- Form: the conflicts in the play cause events that lead to tragedy rather than Romeo's actions. Without the feud between the two families, there would be no need for the Friar's secret plan, and the deaths of Romeo and Juliet would be unlikely to happen
- Form/Structure: events take place in five days and the pace of the action is very fast. This puts more pressure on Romeo to act, and increases the dramatic tension for the audience
- Structure: the dramatic climax of the play occurs at the end of Act 3, which was the traditional placing in a five-act play. Juliet is going to be forced to marry Paris after she has already married in secret to Romeo. The timing of this event is what causes Juliet to seek a solution which, because of Romeo's banishment and lack of communication, leads to the tragic ending.

(AO4)

- many people in the 16th and 17th centuries believed that astrology played some part in setting the course of their lives. So, this idea of 'star crossed lovers' would seem realistic to a contemporary audience
- Shakespeare himself thought fate was all-powerful and uses this play to hint that attempting to go against one's fate can be disastrous
- Italy was a country full of fierce family-orientated squabbles during Shakespeare's time, and, through the play, he shows how these can lead to violence and tragedy, if not resolved. He also highlights the rebellious nature of young people of the time, as the forbidden nature of the couple's love only intensifies their desire to go against their parents
- Romeo fulfils the role of tragic hero, which, in the tradition of Shakespearean tragedy, is where the protagonist fights against his fate without success.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • family honour is significant in the play as it affects the way certain characters behave. It is important to maintain the family name in Verona at this time, especially in rich families such as the Capulets and Montagues, who are very influential because of their wealth and power in society • Romeo's and Juliet's love for each other is forbidden owing to the long-standing feud between their two families. The original source of the conflict is never revealed, but it is clear that neither side is prepared to reconcile their differences, which affects the whole of society significantly • the play opens with a street brawl between the servants of the Capulets and the Montagues, who are trying to preserve the honour of their two houses: 'A dog of the house of Montague moves me'. This street violence occurs often, and Prince Escalus tells the servants that they are 'Rebellious subjects, enemies to peace'. He warns Lord Capulet and Lord Montague that he will hold them responsible for any more violence: 'Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace' • when Romeo, a Montague, attends the Capulet ball uninvited, Tybalt feels that their family honour has been violated: 'It fits when such a villain is a guest: / I'll not endure him'. Lord Capulet, fearful of further trouble, tells Tybalt to 'let him alone' but Tybalt later challenges Romeo to a duel to protect his family honour, which is so significant • when Juliet realises that she has fallen in love with a Montague she realises that it would dishonour her family if they found out: 'My only love sprung from my only hate!' The fact that she has fallen in love with an enemy is a significant event that affects the action which follows • Juliet tells Romeo that she loves him but his name, which represents his family's honour, is the problem: 'Tis but thy name that is my enemy'. Romeo tells her that he would prefer to be killed by her family than live his life without her: 'My life were better ended by their hate, / Than death prorogued, wanting of thy love'. This would be seen as dishonouring his family name • when Romeo and Juliet get married in secret, it is very difficult for them to remain loyal to their family name. Romeo kills Tybalt, Juliet's cousin, thereby, in effect, killing one of his own relations. Juliet's loyalty to her family's honour is now tested: 'O God, did Romeo's hand shed Tybalt's blood?' but she must also remain loyal to her new husband and honour him: 'Shall I speak ill of him that is my husband?' the grief produced by the death of the lovers leads directly to the reconciliation of the Capulets and Montagues, and the family honour is forgotten as Lord Capulet says 'O brother Montague, give me your hand'.

(AO2)

- Language: despite the significance of family honour, when Romeo meets Juliet and falls in love with her, he uses images of the sun and stars to describe her: 'her eyes in heaven / Would through the airy region stream so bright'. These metaphors show that their love is heavenly and beyond the constraints of family honour
- Language: Juliet speaks with oxymorons when she describes Romeo after the death of Tybalt: 'Beautiful tyrant, fiend angelical!' which shows her divided loyalties
- Form: the play is a tragedy in which Shakespeare suggests that parental expectations of pure loyalty are likely to lead only to disaster
- Form/Structure: the Chorus, in sonnet form, pre-warns audiences of the impending tragedy by introducing the 'Two households, both alike in dignity' but telling of the 'ancient grudge' which 'makes civil hands unclean'. This suggests that from the beginning the two families are responsible for the unrest in Verona
- Structure: the 'parents' strife', introduced in the Prologue, is finally ended in the way audiences have been warned about, and the play comes full circle. It is only after the death of five of Verona's young people, that the Capulets and Montagues finally realise that peace is more important than family honour.

(AO4)

- family links were significant in Elizabethan times as they would expect loyalty from all the family, and even from the servants who worked for them
- death was commonplace in Verona in these times and violence pervaded its streets. Duelling to preserve a person's honour or family name was often the cause
- the negative effects of feuding families seeking revenge for the dishonouring of family loyalty were a powerful threat to the stability of Elizabethan society.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 Macbeth	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the Old Man says ‘ ’Tis unnatural ... ‘ after King Duncan’s murder, describing the unnatural events of the night before when he witnessed ‘Hours of dreadful and things strange’. Nature seems to have been overturned as a falcon has been killed by its prey, the mousing owl, and Duncan’s horses have broken out of their stalls and eaten each other. Also, darkness has prevailed although it is daytime - these events have all occurred because of the vicious murder of Duncan the night before when Macbeth upset the natural order of things by killing his king, God’s representative on Earth. The sacrilegious murder has unleashed chaos and confusion on the world: ‘Confusion now hath made his masterpiece’ - a legitimate king and loyal subjects provide order. At the very beginning of the play, the natural order is restored when Macbeth and Banquo lead Duncan’s victorious armies against the Scottish rebels and the Norwegian invaders. The legitimate king is kept in place, he rewards his loyal subjects, and all seems like it could be well in the kingdom - however, the Witches very quickly undermine this natural order. The forces of the supernatural, represented by the Witches in the play, are consistently trying to subvert and undermine the world’s stability. They prey on weak, flawed characters, such as Macbeth, to sow chaos, turning good to bad: ‘Fair is foul, and foul is fair’ - things that are not natural are often connected with madness. Early in the play, Banquo wonders whether he and Macbeth have eaten ‘the insane root’ when they see the Witches. Once he starts to trust the Witches, Macbeth begins to hallucinate, thinking he sees a dagger in the air: ‘art thou but / A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain?’ Later in the play, Lady Macbeth’s guilt drives her to madness - as the unnatural disorder starts to take hold under Macbeth’s reign, Scotland begins to sink into a tyrannical mess. Banquo and then Macduff’s family are murdered, Fleance just escapes with his life and Malcolm and Donalbain have to flee the country. We also hear about terrible problems affecting every aspect of life in the kingdom. Disorder in the structure of society creates chaos everywhere - audiences are shown how brave characters such as Macduff, and later Malcolm, stand up to this tyranny and fight against Macbeth’s disorder, ultimately restoring the natural order of things, as Malcolm takes the crown back to its legitimate home: ‘Behold, where stands / The usurper’s cursed head: the time is free’ - the play ends with a speech from Malcolm, the new king, promising to reward those who have helped to make the country peaceful again, saying he will do all he can to rule wisely ‘by the grace of God’.

(AO2)

- Language: when Macduff discovers Duncan's body, he uses religious metaphors to show how the murder is unholy: 'Most sacrilegious murder hath broke ope / The Lord's anointed temple, and stole thence / The life o' the building'
- Language: when Macbeth sees the dagger, which seems to lead him towards killing Duncan, he says 'Nature seems dead', showing that he knows his actions are now unnatural
- Form: the play is a tragedy with a respected and successful character being brought down by his own fatal flaw of excessive ambition, which leads to his committing unnatural deeds
- Form/Structure: after the murder of Duncan, Macbeth is forever in a hurry, spurred on by his ambition. The pace of the play quickens as Macbeth becomes impatient and demands answers and action. The theme of time racing is related to the chaos that Macbeth has caused
- Structure: the opposing forces of order and disorder run throughout *Macbeth*. We see Shakespearean and medieval views of an ordered society versus chaos.

(AO4)

- Shakespearean audiences believed in the existence of supernatural forces, and they were very superstitious. They thought that witches were capable of subverting nature by creating storms and changing the weather patterns
- Jacobean and Elizabethan audiences believed in the natural order on Earth (as in heaven). This was a belief in a pyramid of existence, with the King at the top, followed by nobles, then knights and merchants and finally peasants at the bottom. The supernatural aimed to undermine this by creating mischief. Subverting the natural order would lead to terrible problems for everyone
- the king was thought to be appointed by God, so if you killed the king, you would be committing a sacrilegious deed against God's will. There was some controversy when Elizabeth died as to whether James, as a Scottish king, was the natural successor to the throne.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
14 <i>Macbeth</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose how far they agree with the view that Lady Macbeth deserves her fate. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Lady Macbeth first appears in the play when she is reading her husband's letter informing her of his meeting with the three Witches and their prophecies, one of which is that he shall be king. She immediately shows her strong ambition by deciding that Macbeth 'shalt be / What thou art promis'd'. However, she is not convinced that her husband is strong enough to do what will be necessary: 'Yet do I fear thy nature; / It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way' • she very quickly decides that she will turn to evil spirits to make her insensitive so that she has no natural feelings of conscience for helping her husband achieve his ambition: 'Come, you spirits', 'unsex me here, / And fill me from the crown to the toe top-full / Of direst cruelty'. This could show that she invites her own fate • from this point in the play, she uses her ambition to be queen to commit treason against King Duncan. Lady Macbeth is so certain in her evil ambition that she even persuades Macbeth to carry out Duncan's murder when he has doubts: 'What beast was't, then, / That made you break this enterprise to me?' • however, underneath her hardness and cunning, she is vulnerable. When Macbeth returns with the daggers by mistake, she reveals that she would not have carried out the murder herself: 'Had he not resembled / My father as he slept, I had done't'. It could be argued that the evil spirits she invited into her soul are now controlling her actions, and she is not acting on her own will • when Macbeth starts to crumble once he has been crowned king, she is not strong enough to stop him from acting rashly and bringing suspicion on himself. In the banquet scene she tries to cover up Macbeth's erratic behaviour when he thinks he sees the ghost of Banquo by dismissing the guests early saying that her husband is not well. She then chides him for the last time: 'What! Quite unmann'd in folly?' but after this point Macbeth acts alone. She cannot influence him anymore and has to accept her fate • later in the play she starts sleepwalking and talking about Duncan's murder in her sleep: 'who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?' Her doctor says she is possessed: 'This disease is beyond my practice'. In the end, she kills herself, overcome with guilt • her ambition, lack of moral scruples, and her ability to manipulate Macbeth lead them down a path of self-destruction, ultimately contributing to both his downfall and hers • most candidates will probably decide that Lady Macbeth deserved her fate because she brought it on herself, but alternative viewpoints, if supported,

are valid: for example, that she was so consumed by evil that she was not acting as herself; that she was acting in the best interests of her husband by trying to give him better opportunities in life; that fate controlled all of their lives and she was powerless to prevent what happened.

(AO2)

- Language: Lady Macbeth's violent language about killing her baby rather than let her husband down, as he has her, would shock the audience through its lack of maternal feelings, which is unnatural: 'I would, while it was smiling in my face, / Have pluck'd my nipple from his boneless gums, / And dash'd the brains out, had I so sworn as you / Have done to this'
- Language: Lady Macbeth uses images of the garden of Eden and the serpent to introduce the idea of evil and deceit: 'look like the innocent flower / But be the serpent under't'. By encouraging Macbeth to deceive others, she could be seen as culpable and manipulative
- Language: once Lady Macbeth has been invaded by evil spirits, she talks with the same sort of double entendre that the Witches use to outwit Macbeth. She tells Duncan 'All our service / In every point done, and then done double', which sounds as though she is being the perfect hostess, but she really means that she will make sure the murder is done properly
- Language/Form: after the murder of Duncan, Lady Macbeth tells her husband 'A little water clears us of this deed' but the blood on their hands is a symbol of their guilt, which keeps reappearing as a motif throughout the tragedy
- Form/Structure: Lady Macbeth's continual 'washing' of invisible blood from her hands illustrates the psychological nature of the play's themes, and the blood is a symbol of her guilt, which will never leave her
- Structure: Lady Macbeth is a strong and manipulative character at the start of the play, and has a lot of power over her husband, but, by the second half, Macbeth has ceased to include her in his plans, and she dies alone. She is not influential in any decisions made in the last two Acts of the play, which may make her seem less deserving of her fate.

(AO4)

- in Jacobean and Elizabethan households, women were supposed to be subservient to their husbands and obey them. Lady Macbeth is the opposite of the typical wife, as she overrules her husband's decisions and persuades him to act against his conscience
- once Lady Macbeth has invoked the evil spirits to enter her body, she would be seen to be possessed by the devil and is often referred to as 'the fourth Witch'
- audiences of the time are likely to have no sympathy for her demise, and would feel that she deserved it because she turned to evil
- through the character of Lady Macbeth, Shakespeare explores the repercussions of going against your position in the Great Chain of Being, and describes the process of following ambition without regard to morality.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
15 The Merchant of Venice	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the play highlights the importance and complexities of wealth. It can influence people's lives in many ways, including who they do business with, their relationships, and even their wellbeing. Almost every character in the play has some sort of financial motivation behind their actions. Several wealthy characters are depicted as unhappy, despite their vast fortunes - in the play, we see that, generally, status is tied to wealth. However, even though Shylock is very wealthy, he is discriminated against because of his religion. He also appears to value his wealth as much as his daughter's happiness. When she elopes with Lorenzo, he cries 'O my ducats! O my daughter!' - money plays an important role in the play and causes lots of issues. The title of the play, referring to Antonio's being a merchant, tells the audience that he makes money by trading. It is his livelihood but one that is unstable because he relies on his ships' returning across the Mediterranean with their cargoes intact. He has 'an argosy cast away coming from Tripolis' - Antonio is a wealthy and respected merchant who is known for his generosity. At the beginning of the play, his friend, Bassanio, asks him for help because he does not have enough money to visit Portia as a potential suitor. It could be argued that Bassanio's motives for wooing Portia are questionable, fuelled by his desire to marry a wealthy lady: 'In Belmont is a lady richly left'. The importance of wealth is shown by the fact that, in order to help his friend, Antonio has to agree to be guarantor for a loan from Shylock, a Jewish moneylender, who charges high interest rates and is portrayed as greedy and obsessed with money - Shylock hates Antonio but agrees to lend the money provided that Antonio signs a bond to yield a pound of his own flesh, if he is unable to repay the loan on time. It could be considered rash of Antonio to enter into such a bond with an enemy. He tells Shylock that they can never be friends: 'If thou wilt lend this money, lend it not / As to thy friends, ... But lend it rather to thine enemy' - Jessica takes Shylock's gold as a show of power over her father when she runs away from home to be with Lorenzo. However, Jessica's relationship with Lorenzo is more important to her than her father's wealth: 'though I am a daughter to his blood / I am not to his manners' - Portia is a wealthy heiress in Belmont, but she is bound by her father's decree in his will that she can only marry a suitor chosen by the casket challenge. Potential husbands assume that the gold casket is the one that holds the prize of her hand in marriage, because they think that the casket worth the most money will hold the prize. However, Bassanio chooses lead, which shows that he does not judge wealth at face value. Portia loves Bassanio even when she finds out he is in debt to others

- at the end of the play, Shylock is ordered to surrender half of his money and property to the state and the other half to Antonio. All of his wealth is seized, and he is forced to convert to Christianity. His wealth has not brought him happiness in life and his greed has led to his downfall
- the play shows that, despite its importance, wealth does not bring happiness by itself. For true happiness to be achieved, money and possessions must be used wisely to help those in need. Love and friendship are shown to be more valuable than money.

(AO2)

- Language: the scroll in the golden casket reads: 'All that glisters is not gold; / Often have you heard that told', using alliteration and rhyming couplet to teach the Prince of Morocco a lesson not to be greedy and desire riches
- Language: Shakespeare uses a metaphor to describe Bassanio's entry onstage, purporting to be wealthy: 'So likely an ambassador of love'. He believes it is important to look like a wealthy man but, in reality, he relies on others to lend him money
- Language: Bassanio shows that although he is a nobleman, he is not solely concerned with money and riches: 'The world is still deceiv'd with ornament'. He uses the image of rotten food being disguised with spices to show that appearance can often differ from reality. Unlike the other rich suitors, he is not fooled by the appearance of wealth
- Language/Structure: the repetition in Shylock's speech in the trial scene shows how his life is destroyed by his punishment: 'You take my house', 'you take my life'. His wealth is his life
- Form/Structure: Antonio shares the play's happy ending as he does not have to give his life to pay his debt. In contrast, Shylock is shamed and loses everything, including his daughter
- Structure: the plot hinges on Antonio's plight and his business as a merchant is contrasted with that of Shylock, whose wealth comes from moneylending.

(AO4)

- Venetian wealth was based on maritime commerce, initially in local products such as fish and salt from the lagoon, but rapidly expanding to include rich stores of merchandise, as Venice became the entrepôt between Europe and the Middle East and Asia
- money-lending led to conflicts in Shakespeare's time, especially as most lenders were Jews. Civil authorities had to be forced to pass laws to ensure that Jews got their money back from debtors
- Christian leaders in Venice were keen to stop the Jews from doing too much business. Jews were forced to live in ghettos, but they succeeded in spite of their treatment.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
16 <i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose how far they agree with the view that Shylock is '... an inhuman wretch / Uncapable of pity'. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • the Duke makes this statement in the court at the trial scene after Portia has asked the Duke to make the final decision about Shylock's fate. Shylock, a Jewish moneylender in Venice, is often depicted as greedy, vengeful and miserly in the play. However, candidates may view his statement as biased against Shylock • candidates may take the view that Shylock is not necessarily a villain, but he is an antagonist who offers a different view of the way some wealthy businessmen are treated in Venice. He is a devout Jew, having a passion for his race and religion, and speaks eloquently about the injustices suffered by the Jews. The centuries of oppression of his Jewish race by the Christians has embittered his soul. In his soliloquy, in the middle of the play, he says 'Hath not a Jew eyes? Hath not / a Jew hands, organs, dimensions, senses, affections, / passions? ... If you prick us, do we / not bleed?' • despite his avarice and greed, his frequent mentions of the cruelty he has endured at Christian hands make it hard to label him a natural-born monster. Candidates may view him as a victim of discrimination, but his role as a victim in the play could be viewed as partly his own doing • Shylock wants revenge against Antonio because, as Shylock puts it, Antonio hates Jews. Shylock explains his enmity: 'I will feed fat the ancient grudge I bear him'. He also has a bias against Antonio as a Christian and hates him even more for Antonio's practice of lending money without interest, undermining Shylock's usury business. Shylock wants revenge for years of Antonio's mistreatment • his opportunity for revenge comes when Antonio's argosies are lost at sea and Bassanio cannot pay back the 3000 ducats owed to Shylock by the agreed deadline. When Tubal tells him the news, Shylock says 'I'll plague him, I'll torture him – I'm glad of it'. This could make him seem inhuman • Shylock's coldly calculated attempt to secure revenge for the wrongs done to him by murdering his persecutor, Antonio, prevents us from viewing him in a primarily positive light. Shakespeare gives us unmistakably human moments but, ultimately, Shylock is shown to be incapable of showing any pity, and would happily go ahead with cutting off his 'pound of flesh', even if it means killing Antonio in the process • in the end, owing to the efforts of Portia, Shylock is charged with the attempted murder of a Christian, carrying a possible death penalty, and Antonio is freed without punishment. Shylock is then ordered to surrender half of his wealth and property to the state and the other half to Antonio

- Jessica, Shylock's daughter, elopes with a Christian, Lorenzo, which further incurs Shylock's wrath. She blames her father's treatment of her for her disowning him: 'Our house is hell, and thou a merry devil'. She also steals his money as she considers that he cares more about that than her. She is aware of the cunning reputation he has in Venice: 'To be asham'd to be my father's child!' However, she also causes Shylock grief by swapping his dead wife's ring for a monkey, which could be considered a cruel act and reveals his human side
- even though Shylock is viewed as both a victim and a villain, it could be argued that there is stronger evidence of him being a villain since he seems driven by revenge more than anything and will not consider forgiveness or pity.

(AO2)

- Language: the Duke is in charge of trying the case and is on Antonio's side. This would seem to skew justice in Antonio's favour. The Duke says Shylock is 'void and empty / From any dram of mercy', using language that is degrading to a human
- Language: Shylock uses anaphora (repeated phrases) to add weight to his words when he refuses Portia's offer to give him three times the money he is owed: 'I'll have my bond, speak not against my bond; / I have sworn an oath that I will have my bond'
- Form: on the surface, the main difference between the Christian characters and Shylock appears to be that the Christian characters value human relationships over business ones, whereas Shylock is mainly interested in making money and taking vengeance on the Venetian businessmen
- Form: although Shylock appears to be in the right legally and entitled to his 'pound of flesh', the Duke and Portia ensure that the court judgement results in a more lenient sentence for Antonio, and the outcome is reversed so that Shylock becomes the victim of the tragi-comedy
- Structure: Shylock's function in this play is to be the obstacle, the man who stands in the way of the love stories and happy outcomes.

(AO4)

- usury was forbidden to Christians by the Church in the Middle Ages
- and, as a consequence, money lending was controlled by the Jews; as a rule, it was usually the only occupation which the law allowed to them. Belief in the avarice of Jews was widespread in Elizabethan times
- during Shakespeare's time, anti-Judaism was a pervasive problem in European society. Shakespeare used this play to draw his audience's attention to this social issue
- the Venetian Jews had to live in a ghetto, which would be located outside of the main city with gates that would be locked at a certain time. Each had to wear a distinguishing item of clothing.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
17 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Mary Bennet explains the significance of pride at the beginning of the novel when discussing Mr Darcy's proud behaviour at the ball. She explains that 'Pride relates more to our opinion of ourselves, vanity to what we would have others think of us' • pride is a significant theme in the novel, and the effects of pride are shown in the characters' interactions with each other. Pride is a constant presence in the characters' attitudes and treatment of each other, colouring their judgements and leading them to make rash mistakes • Elizabeth Bennet's pride is hurt when Mr Darcy does not dance with her at the ball at the beginning of the novel, and she lets this prejudice her view of him. She judges Mr Darcy too quickly and without enough information. However, she eventually realises that her pride and prejudice have led her to misunderstand his character • Mr Darcy's pride about his social rank is significant as it makes him look down on anyone who is not in his immediate circle. However, his pride may be viewed as being influenced by his aunt, Lady Catherine De Bourgh, whose excessive pride leads to prejudice. Elizabeth shows him how his pride can lead to blindness, and the importance of looking beyond appearance • as a result of Mr Darcy's significant display of pride early in the novel, the Bennet family and their neighbours become prejudiced against him. Although he behaves rudely by refusing to dance with Elizabeth and not being friendlier, he does not actually harm anyone. This single interaction is not enough to truly reveal his character. Nonetheless, the bad impression he makes leads many other characters to make up their minds about who he is. For example, Mrs Bennet calls him 'a most disagreeable, horrid man' • Mr Collins is another example of a character who remains excessively proud throughout the novel but also vain. His role as a clergyman gives him a sense of self-importance, thinking that everyone wants to hear his ponderous speeches and boasting about his patron. He is offended when Elizabeth rejects his marriage proposal but quickly proposes to Charlotte Lucas instead, showing that a wife is just a status symbol to bolster his pride. His lack of development is significant as it contrasts the growth of the characters of Elizabeth and Mr Darcy • both Elizabeth and Mr Darcy must overcome feelings of pride and prejudice to realise their love for one another. Mr Darcy does this first, and it is not an easy process for him. When he first proposes to Elizabeth, he makes it clear that his pride has led him to struggle against his attraction to her. He does not want to fall in love with her because he is embarrassed by her family. However, he cannot help it. As he explains, 'In vain have I struggled. It will not do. My feelings will not be repressed'. He lets go of his pride in order to propose to her

- Elizabeth is much more stubborn in overcoming her prejudice because she is also proud and does not like to be treated as inferior. She is offended when Mr Darcy says insulting things about her family when he proposes to her. She is also still prejudiced by the way she believes Mr Darcy has treated Jane Bennet and Mr Wickham. Elizabeth does not start to rethink her assumptions until Mr Darcy explains what actually happened between himself and Mr Wickham. Once her prejudice has been challenged, she becomes more open to wondering if she might have been wrong about Mr Darcy and realises that her pride could have ruined her future happiness
- in the novel, pride is shown to be an obstacle to forming lasting relationships, and excessive pride leading to vanity can impact an entire family.

(AO2)

- Language: Elizabeth uses a list of negative adjectives to describe Mr Collins' pride: 'Mr Collins is a conceited, pompous, narrow-minded, silly man'
- Language: Mr Darcy's coldness towards Elizabeth at the Meryton assembly is cutting and insulting. He is rude and dismissive about her: 'She is tolerable; but not handsome enough to tempt me', which is significant in showing his excessive pride
- Language/Structure: Lady Catherine's proud, upper-class attitudes lead to outrageous rudeness: 'I take no leave of you, Miss Bennet. I send no compliments to your mother'
- Form/Structure: Mrs Bennet's pride is significant as it leads her to the foolish obsession with marrying off her daughters at all costs. The approach she takes to this end has the effect of alienating the very people she seeks to attract as potential suitors for her daughters
- Structure: the novel's title, *Pride and Prejudice*, encompasses the theme of pride that is shown throughout the novel.

(AO4)

- in Jane Austen's time, being proud usually meant someone thought he or she was better than other people or was not open to interacting with different kinds of people. Men found pride in their breeding, wealth or careers suitable for the upper classes, such as the militia and the Church. Making a good match in marriage was a source of pride for women at the time
- Mr Darcy's pride would be understood owing to his wealth and high social position. He is used to being treated as a social superior and an authority figure, and social codes of behaviour ensure that he is treated with respect by characters of lower social position
- members of the land-owning gentry enjoyed considerable power and would have been likely to look down on those who earned their money through trade.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
18 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Elizabeth Bennet is important as the heroine of the novel and the protagonist around whom most events occur. She is less beautiful than her elder sister, Jane, but has a natural vivacity and endearing quality of openness. She is Mr Bennet's favourite as she shares his sense of humour and clarity in social matters, such as Mr Collins' introductory letter, which they both find amusing • Elizabeth takes pride in herself and her identity and is very clear about what she wants from life: she wants to marry for love, not money or status. One of Elizabeth's strongest traits is her determination, which becomes important to the outcomes of the novel • Elizabeth is more intellectual than her sisters and she values independence of character and personal virtue, which make her unconventional. She is bold and intelligent, with a witty sense of humour, which is what attracts Mr Darcy to her. She considers herself to be a good judge of character. However, throughout the novel, she realises that she is not perfect: she does misjudge people at times, and her pride leads her to make mistakes • Mr Darcy, in particular, is attracted by her 'dark eyes', although he is initially unimpressed by her looks: 'She is tolerable; but not handsome enough to tempt me'. It is her strength of character that he falls in love with as he learns to look beyond the exterior of a person • her first meeting with Mr Darcy at the Meryton assembly is significant because he upsets her pride: she is shunned by him and insulted. She tells Charlotte Lucas: 'I could easily forgive <i>his</i> pride, if he had not mortified <i>mine</i>'. Importantly, however, he does provide a challenge to her individuality and makes her see the weaknesses in herself and her family • Elizabeth is not afraid to voice her opinion and gets angry at Mr Darcy when he proposes to her. She even says: 'I have every reason in the world to think ill of you' and proceeds to list her reasons. This is important as it contrasts Mr Darcy's view of the situation • Elizabeth proudly refuses to back down from her preconceptions of Mr Darcy's character. Yet, after reading Mr Darcy's letter, Elizabeth realises that her wrongful prejudices have misled her, thus opening the novel up to the larger meaning of the importance of self-discovery. She realises, after reading Mr Darcy's letter, that 'she had been blind, partial, prejudiced, absurd' • as a protagonist she is important in uncovering the truth. She proves her strength and determination and relies on her insight as she reveals her opinions about Mr Bingley to Jane. She is also bold enough to speak to her parents about Mr Collins, pointing out that he is not a suitable husband for any of the Bennet daughters. Mr Bennet knows this already but has not the strength to discuss it with his wife

- ultimately, it is her resilience and sense of humour that brings her happiness and that of others. Although her sisters, Jane and Lydia, as well as her good friend, Charlotte Lucas, are all married by the end of the novel, Elizabeth is important in showing the most fulfilling married relationship.

(AO2)

- Language: Elizabeth's sense of humour is emphasised as an important quality. She is described as having 'a lively, playful disposition, which delighted in anything ridiculous'
- Language/Structure: when Elizabeth learns of Mr Wickham's deceit, she realises that she was tricked and manipulated by him. She admits he had 'all the appearance of goodness'. This is an important turning point in the novel where she realises that she cannot always trust her judgement, and it makes her view Mr Darcy in a different light
- Language/Structure: after Charlotte marries Mr Collins, Elizabeth feels duty-bound to accept her invitation to visit even though she would prefer not to: 'Elizabeth could not refuse, though she foresaw little pleasure in the visit'. This visit leads her to become reacquainted with Mr Darcy
- Form: an example of Elizabeth's importance in increasing tension and humour in the novel by doing something unexpected, is when she insists on walking from Longbourn to Netherfield, and the Bingley sisters say that 'she looked really almost wild'
- Structure: Elizabeth is the protagonist of the novel, and the major conflict revolves around her struggle to find a compatible husband despite the obstacles presented by both social conventions and her own lack of self-awareness. She encounters several antagonists who create obstacles between her and a happy marriage.

(AO4)

- Elizabeth is determined to speak her mind and breaks the social rules imposed on women by Georgian society. She could be viewed as an independent feminist heroine who challenges traditional gender roles and societal expectations
- love was considered a less important factor in a good match than social and economic considerations
- marriage was considered an important goal for all young women at the time
- Mr Bennet's close relationship with Elizabeth could have been perceived as unusual, as, when Austen wrote the novel, there was typically more distance between a father and daughter.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
19 Great Expectations	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Abel Magwitch and Pip are unlikely characters to become acquainted: Magwitch is an escaped convict, and Pip is a seven-year-old orphan. However, Magwitch plays a major role in Pip's development, and their relationship is complex • when Pip runs into Magwitch in the marsh, he is terrified. Magwitch grabs Pip and threatens to cut his throat if he screams again. Magwitch tricks Pip into believing that he has an accomplice, a terrible young man who will tear out and eat Pip's heart and liver if Pip does not help them. Magwitch demands Pip to get him 'wittles' and a file, which he unwillingly does through fear • the impressions that Pip carries around of Magwitch for years are of a brutal, dirty, conniving, threatening criminal who forced him to steal. This affects their relationship when they meet again later in the novel • after Magwitch is arrested and facing deportation, he is protective of Pip. He lies by telling the soldiers that it was him, Magwitch, who stole from the blacksmith's house, which is the beginning of Magwitch's role as his protector and later benefactor • once he has served his sentence in New South Wales, his desire to make Pip a gentleman becomes his way of achieving salvation. Magwitch is aware that the law can be administered unjustly, so he hopes that, by his making Pip a gentleman, Pip can avoid all kinds of ill-treatment because of his social class: 'I've come to the old country to see my gentleman spend his money like a gentleman. That'll be my pleasure' • after Magwitch appears in London and reveals himself as Pip's benefactor, he tells his life story to Pip and Herbert Pocket. Magwitch makes it clear that his life of crime is rooted in impoverishment and neglect: 'what the Devil was I to do? I must put something into my stomach' • once Pip realises that Magwitch is his benefactor, not Miss Havisham, he feels like he cannot accept any more money from him. He knows Magwitch was a convict and that makes the money seem tainted • Pip feels repulsed by Magwitch but also feels a responsibility to hide and protect him. Magwitch, as a deported criminal, would be without doubt sentenced to death if recognised by the authorities. When Magwitch is finally arrested, Pip vows 'I will never stir from your side' • later in the novel, when Magwitch is declining in health and is being held in the infirmary, Pip visits him every day. In his final moments he informs him that his child, Estella, is alive. Pip goes on to tell him that she is a beautiful lady and that he, Pip, is in love with her. Upon hearing this information, Magwitch kisses Pip's hand, lowers it to his chest, and dies • after Magwitch's death, Pip falls into a feverish illness. He is also arrested for debt and nearly carted away to prison; he is spared only because of his extreme ill health. The importance of Magwitch in his life and his feelings of guilt after Magwitch's death are clear

- the relationship between Magwitch and Pip is important because Magwitch helps Pip understand the world differently. Magwitch also acts as one of the father figures to Pip (along with Joe Gargery and Mr Jaggers). Although he terrifies Pip when he is a boy, Magwitch grows to love Pip as his own son and tries to help him to become a gentleman later in life. Pip eventually accepts and loves Magwitch as a human being with flaws.

(AO2)

- Language: Pip's first description of Magwitch uses polysyndeton and alliteration to emphasise how scared he is of him: a man 'who limped and shivered, and glared and growled; and whose teeth chattered in his head as he seized me by the chin'
- Language: Dickens criticises the use of the death penalty through his portrayal of Magwitch's trial. Accused men and women were 'Penned in the dock' and are described as 'wretched creatures', which shows his view of Magwitch as a sympathetic one
- Form: as a bildungsroman, the novel shows Pip learns life lessons: that a person's standing in society should be founded on the respect shown to others and moral conscience, rather than on the basis of social class
- Structure: Pip is finally able to accept and love Magwitch because he sees him as a human being with flaws. Pip is no longer judgemental of people
- Structure: Magwitch's illness and death create the opportunity for Pip to finally show integrity and loyalty to someone he has come to love.

(AO4)

- Charles Dickens' father had been appointed to one of the principal naval dockyards in Chatham. Dickens must have witnessed the convicts who worked at unloading, and the marshes at Cooling, northeast of Chatham, off which the galley ships lay
- the novel vividly portrays the stark social divisions of Victorian England through the contrasting characters of Magwitch and Pip
- Dickens wrote the novel with the aim of making his readers aware of certain social issues he felt needed changing, one being the unfair criminal justice system, which saw his own father imprisoned for debt.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
20 Great Expectations	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • in the novel, crime is presented as being prevalent in Victorian society, and the punishments severe. Prison sentences are long, and the death penalty is used widely. Criminals, such as Abel Magwitch, are often transported abroad to the colonies and not allowed to return • Dickens introduces the reader to several different types of criminal and crime, some of which are presented more sympathetically than others • the first criminal introduced in the novel is Magwitch. He is described as a stereotypical convict: a fearful man 'with an iron on his leg'. Magwitch has become a thief in order to live. He compels Pip to steal 'wittles' and a file from Joe Gargery and Mrs Joe and, in doing so, he pulls Pip into a world of criminality. However, later he redeems himself by trying to atone for his crimes and make a better life for Pip • Compeyson is another criminal, but he is presented more negatively. He is a thief and cheat who takes advantage of others, such as Magwitch. Compeyson and Magwitch are caught for using stolen money, but Compeyson gets a lighter sentence because he appears more like a gentleman. Magwitch tells Pip 'I noticed first of all what a gentleman Compeyson looked'. Compeyson also commits the moral crime of cheating Miss Havisham out of her money and jilting her on her wedding day • Dolge Orlick is a villainous criminal in the novel. He assaults Mrs Joe, traps Pip to kill him, and helps Compeyson in his plot against Magwitch. Orlick hunts Pip down, much like Compeyson hunts Magwitch, and his violent and predatory behaviour contrasts with the more humorous portrayal of Magwitch at the beginning of the novel. His crimes seem far worse, and he has no redeeming features in contrast to Magwitch • through the figure of Magwitch, Dickens suggests to the reader that harsh punishment and failing to deal with the underlying issues of crime, such as poverty, only make matters worse and cause criminals to reoffend. Magwitch's entire life has been a never-ending cycle of jail-time, and he has never been given the help he has needed to break that trend • Magwitch's trial is short and swift. It inevitably concludes that Magwitch is guilty of returning illegally to England and must therefore be condemned to death, even though he has repented of his crimes • the legal system is so overcrowded that no fewer than 32 prisoners are receiving the death sentence at once when Magwitch is tried: 'A great gallery full of people – a large theatrical audience – looked on, as the two-and-thirty and the Judge were solemnly confronted'. Dickens suggests that justice is all a performance and a sham • Mr Jaggers is presented as one of the more sympathetic legal figures, although his dealings with Pip are always very businesslike. When Pip

	tells him he felt misled about his benefactor, he answers coolly: 'I am not at all responsible for that'. He also has managed to use the legal system to get his housekeeper, Molly, acquitted when she was charged with strangling a woman of whom she was jealous - the two types of prison portrayed in the novel are Newgate Prison, the main prison in London at the time, and the prison ships known as the Hulks. Neither of these were particularly fit for humans, and they both seem to have a deep effect on Pip. The countryside where the Hulks are moored is dark and dismal marshland. The ships seem to be covered in the same chains as the prisoners: 'Cribbed and barred and moored by massive rusty chains, the prison-ship seemed in my young eyes to be ironed like the prisoners' - there are two kinds of justice presented in the novel: the justice of the law courts and the natural justice of the way we punish ourselves and each other for our crimes. Some characters of higher social standing commit different sorts of crime and seemingly get away with it, such as Bentley Drummle's abuse of Estella. Dickens shows that those who are supposed to uphold the law are often criminals themselves. (AO2) - Language: Dickens uses a simile to suggest the brutal conditions on the Hulks: 'like a wicked version of Noah's ark' - Language: Dickens' description of the dock presents the cruel treatment of those on trial: 'Penned in the dock ... were the two-and-thirty men and women'. The word 'penned', which is usually used about cattle or sheep, compares the prisoners to animals - Language: Magwitch uses repetition to show how he could not break out of the cycle of crime: 'In jail and out of jail, in jail and out of jail, in jail and out of jail. There, you got it. That's my life pretty much' - Form: from the handcuffs Joe mends at the smithy to the gallows at the prison in London, the imagery of crime and criminal justice pervades the book, following Pip wherever he goes - Structure: crime is presented as a powerful psychological force in the novel, and the protagonist, Pip, becomes entangled in a complex web of crime as the novel progresses. (AO4) - Dickens was a lifelong critic of the British legal system, which he thought was corrupt and harsh and only encouraged criminals to carry on offending - he seems to have had a particular distrust of lawyers, probably from experiencing first-hand the impact their decisions can have, as Dickens' father, John Dickens, was jailed for his debts - although the justice system was gradually being reformed in Victorian times, there was still much about it that we would consider harsh and unfair today, such as the legal system confiscating money that Magwitch gives to Pip because Magwitch has been a criminal, even though it was earned legally.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
21 <i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to decide how far they agree that the characters are hypocritical, and responses should be assessed on the ideas presented • hypocrisy is the practice of claiming to have moral standards that one's own behaviour does not meet, and there are many examples of this shown in the novel. The city's inhabitants are Puritans, but many of them have fallen short of their standards in one way or another. However, some candidates may argue that the Puritans in the novel believe in the Old Testament rules rather than the New, so may not be seen to be acting hypocritically in not applying the Christian rules of forgiveness and leniency • Hester Prynne's sin is brought out in the public eye of scrutiny at the beginning. She is instantly branded a sinner, and the embodiment of the devil himself. The townspeople judge her and cast her aside, denying her any form of redemption, even when she has confessed her sins and served a prison sentence. Some of them have also committed unconfessed sins, which shows their hypocrisy • Hester acknowledges her sin and, even though she carries this burden honourably, she is still vilified for years. Although Hester has a kind and generous nature, her charitable work is unappreciated. Hawthorne tells us: 'Except for that small expenditure in the decoration of her infant, Hester bestowed all her superfluous means in charity, on wretches less miserable than herself, and who not unfrequently insulted the hand that fed them' • Reverend Arthur Dimmesdale is revered by the townspeople as a saint, but he has committed adultery with Hester and allows her to bear the shame and punishment alone. Because he does not reveal his sin, Hester's co-sinner is glorified: 'They deemed the young clergyman a miracle of holiness. They fancied him the mouthpiece of Heaven's messages of wisdom, and rebuke, and love'. However, he does not admit to his affair with Hester for seven years, which is hypocritical • Roger Chillingworth hypocritically claims to be a benevolent doctor but is secretly consumed by hatred for Dimmesdale and desire for vengeance. The people of the town trust him in his role as a physician, typically seen by the Puritan community as a position of respect, but Hawthorne reveals his true nature: 'This diabolical agent had the Divine permission, for a season, to burrow into the clergyman's intimacy, and plot against his soul' • Governor Bellingham professes to be good and pious but is unable to apply the Christian principle of forgiveness. His sister, Mistress Hibbens, admits to practising witchcraft and meeting the 'Black Man', the Devil, in the woods but this is overlooked by the townspeople because she is the Governor's sister. As the novel's events unfold, the 'Black Man' is associated with both Chillingworth and Dimmesdale as well as Mistress Hibbins, which shows the town's hypocrisy in condemning Hester

- Hester is marked with a scarlet letter, but she develops an intuition to sense the sins of others, even when they are disguised. She realises that Chillingworth is trying to harm Dimmesdale and tries to protect him by suggesting that Dimmesdale flees with them together as a family to the Old World. She spends her life protecting Dimmesdale's name, even warning Pearl not to react to him: 'But [Dimmesdale] will not greet thee to-day; nor must thou greet him'
- instead of wearing their sins on their chest, as Hester is commanded to do, many of the people of Salem become hypocrites as they act in opposition to their own beliefs, hiding ugly truths under pious faces. In reality, Hester becomes one of the only honest people in the novel.

(AO2)

- Language: the word 'chilling' in the surname 'Chillingworth', chosen by himself, has connotations of violence and cruelty, revealing his true evil nature
- Language/Structure: Dimmesdale uses an exclamation towards the end of the novel to show his relief at finally revealing the truth. It is only at this point that Dimmesdale feels at peace with the world: 'Had either of these agonies been wanting, I had been lost for ever!'
- Language/Structure: it is significant that the novel is entitled *The Scarlet Letter* as it represents the shame and sin of Hester. It is symbolic of hypocrisy as the Puritans interpreted the letter: 'The scarlet letter was her passport into regions where other women dared not tread'
- Form: the novel is ironic: Hester's apparent sin is committing adultery; however, the major underlying sin that Hawthorne exploits is hypocrisy
- Form: as a satirical novel, Hawthorne is constantly hinting at the true nature of some of characters' words and actions
- Form/Structure: Pearl questions why Dimmesdale has a tendency to keep 'his hand over his heart'. As Pearl is a child, she does not understand that Dimmesdale is expressing his hidden guilt through his actions
- Structure: Hester's desire to protect Dimmesdale and love her child, turn her into a stronger person and she becomes a heroine.

(AO4)

- the Puritan society thought that it was their job to punish people severely who committed crime because they believed they were doing God's work and preventing sin and evil from spreading
- living in colonial Puritan New England, Hester endures public humiliation for her sins but Hawthorne satirises their actions by showing that the sins of her persecutors are greater than hers
- adultery was considered a very serious sin in Puritan communities that settled in America. It was punishable as a crime and those committing adultery were treated very harshly.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
22 <i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose any character that they consider is presented as being most affected by the affair between Hester Prynne and Arthur Dimmesdale. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • in <i>The Scarlet Letter</i> the affair between Hester and Dimmesdale affects multiple characters, including Hester herself, Dimmesdale, Pearl, Roger Chillingworth and the townsfolk of Boston, Massachusetts • Hester is found guilty of adultery. She is presented as isolated and abused by the community, suffering public ridicule and shame by being forced to wear the letter 'A', in 'scarlet fantastically embroidered with gold thread, upon her bosom!' • Dimmesdale is presented as a Puritan minister who suffers a slow death of internal shame and torment from hiding the truth about the affair. His pain is so overwhelming that he feels he no longer has the strength or will to continue living, especially while feeling the guilt and shame of his sin on his shoulders: 'There was an air about this young minister, – an apprehensive, a startled, a half-frightened look, – as of a being who felt himself quite astray and at a loss in the pathway of human existence' • because Dimmesdale is incapable of confessing that he was Hester's lover and Pearl's father, he substitutes self-punishment. His ever-present guilt and boundless penance cause him an ongoing mental struggle of remorse and his conscience, as well as deep physical pain from deprivation and self-inflicted wounds. At his death he reveals that he too has been wearing the scarlet letter 'A' secretly tattooed on his skin • Pearl, Hester's daughter, is presented as emotionally and psychologically affected by the affair and her mother's enforced isolation and shame. Hester believes that her daughter is her treasure, which is why she chose to name her Pearl, and she has inherited Hester's spirit and disposition. She is wise beyond her years and can see things that others cannot, especially in nature: 'Pearl, seeing the rose bushes, began to cry for a red rose and would not be pacified' • in the forest, when Dimmesdale kisses Pearl's forehead in an attempt to mollify her, she immediately goes to the brook and washes off the kiss. She rejects Dimmesdale's love and is unable to receive love from anyone but her mother. Ironically, the townspeople spread rumours that her father is the Devil • Chillingworth, Hester's husband, is presented as being affected by his wife's affair by feeling intense jealousy. He becomes obsessed with seeking revenge on Dimmesdale. He hides his feelings of anger and hatred in order to plot his revenge, thereby committing the further sin of deceit. He comes to symbolise the devil and is often described as dark, misshapen and shrivelled

- Hester is the only person in town who knows Chillingworth's real identity, and she reminds him that she has kept this secret. She realises that she only married him because she was young and submitted to his pressure and that of her family. He acknowledges that she never loved him and that he committed wrong first by stealing her youth in making her marry him: 'Ye that have wronged me are not sinful'
- the affair affects the whole atmosphere of the community as well as the main characters. Hester is spared execution only because the Puritans of Boston decided it would benefit the community to transform her into a 'living sermon against sin'. Seeing Hester and her daughter, the product of her sinful affair, about the town is a constant reminder of the punishment waiting for sinners.

(AO2)

- Language: Hester suggests Chillingworth is like the 'Black Man' because he lures others into sin and affects their happiness
- Language: Hester uses an oxymoron when she describes Pearl: 'She is my happiness! She is my torture, none the less'. This presents the contrasting ways that having an illegitimate daughter affects her
- Language/Structure: Chillingworth vociferously vows to find out the identity of Pearl's father, a determination that drives the plot. He repeats the exclamation 'he will be known!' that presents him as merciless
- Language/Structure: throughout the novel, Hester is presented as a survivor who makes the best of her difficult situation: 'her beauty shone out, and made a halo of the misfortune and ignominy in which she was enveloped'. She does not allow her unjust treatment to affect her judgement
- Form/Structure: the novel's psychological focus explores the nature of suffering and presents its effect on the lives of individuals
- Structure: the scarlet letter that is sewn to Hester's clothing is symbolic of the suffering that endures throughout the novel.

(AO4)

- adultery would psychologically damage the moral order of the Puritans in Boston who believed in the Old Testament values of sin and harsh punishment
- affairs of this sort were considered not just a sin, but a crime in the Puritan settlement of the Massachusetts Bay Colony of the 1600s
- American identity is at the heart of Hawthorne's novel, considering the tensions that lie between free will and religious observance.

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